



Sennheiser HD 500 BAM

Clear, convenient, and modular upgrade

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Most of the folks use a single pair of headphones to jump between music, video calls, occasional gaming, and editing timelines. And if you own a wired headphone without a built-in microphone, you may want to invest in a mic attachment. While reviewing the HD 505 Copper, I felt the need for a built-in mic. Gladly, a brand like Sennheiser has a wide range of audio products, including the Sennheiser HD 500 BAM. It is a boom arm microphone that is compatible with select HD 500 series headphones. You just have to replace the default wire with the mic cable, and your headphone becomes a wired headset that can be used for gaming, calls, etc. But how good is the mic? We shall find that out below.

For the purposes of testing, Sennheiser sent us a unit of this mic and a pair of HD 560S headphones. Since the HD 560S is an older pair but still considered one of the safest entry points into open-back neutral listening, we shall still see how it fares in 2026 and how the two devices work in conjunction.

How HD 500 BAM works

The HD 500 BAM is a boom arm microphone compatible with headphones such as the Sennheiser HD 560S, HD 550, HD 505, etc. It plugs into the same 2.5mm locking port on the earcup where the regular audio cable connects. You have to twist and release the default cable and insert this one, and lock it with a twist.

Further, the mic cable consists of:

- A fixed boom arm microphone
- An inline control module with volume adjustment
- A physical mute switch
- A standard 3.5mm end for connection to laptops, PCs or audio interfaces

There is no software layer, no drivers and no app. It is entirely plug-and-play. So, if you have a compatible headphone, you can easily convert it into a headset for serious listening. You do not need a separate gaming headset or USB mic for communication. The HD 500 BAM merges both worlds.

There is also a splitter in the box for those desktops with separate headphone and microphone jacks.

Design and integration with HD 560S

Visually, the Sennheiser HD 500 BAM blends well with the HD 560S. The plastic finish and black colour match the headphone's design. The earmuffs are soft, and you get two extra replacement muffs. The whole appearance is sober, not flashy, which aligns with Sennheiser's broader design language in this segment. On the cuboid-shaped inline control module, there's the brand logo.

The boom arm is slim and flexible. It can be positioned close to the mouth without entering your field of vision. Once adjusted, it stays in place during long calls or gaming sessions. But if you want to position it differently, you can.

The cable length is adequate for desk setups, and the quality is also fine. It doesn't add much to an already light headphone. The whole setup is suitable for multi-hour usage. I used it with my laptop and phone.

The inline control module sits mid-cable, closer to the chest region. The volume wheel and mute switch are easy to access and tactile. The mute button